

PUNCHLINE

Twist the words. Light the page. Change the ending.

DRAFT / TEAM DETAILS PENDING

2D PUZZLE PLATFORMER / DESKTOP BROWSER / 10-15 MINUTES

You are **Snap**, a background comic character carrying a flash camera. Printed **BAM!** effects are dormant force emitters. Twist their direction, position yourself or a prop in their burst zone, then flash the word to make it physically happen. Escape the panels and redirect the villain's final punch to earn the last frame.

1 TWIST THE WORD



Rotate in 90-degree steps

2 FLASH THE LIGHT



Light activates one word

3 CHANGE THE ACTION



Launch yourself or shove props

THE PLAYER LOOP

Aim. Select a visible word within camera range; solid obstacles block targeting. **Twist.** Rotate it left or right in quarter turns; an arrow and zone outline show the effect. **Flash.** Movable objects in that zone, including Snap and crates, receive a fixed, capped impulse in the chosen direction. **Advance.** Use the launch or shove to reach a ledge, trigger a switch or open the next panel.

Sound words provide traversal: there is no standard jump button. Flashes recharge automatically. Failed launches return to the panel checkpoint; a one-button reset restores the entire panel.

THREE THEMES INSIDE THE SAME MECHANIC

COMIC	Printed onomatopoeia becomes a physical, interactive object. Panels, ink and speech bubbles carry the presentation.
TWIST	Quarter-turn rotation changes force direction. The finale turns a finishing blow into the player's escape.
LIGHT	The camera flash activates the selected word. Aiming identifies the target; it stays inert until the light pulse.

A SHORT ARC WITH A PLAYABLE PAYOFF

Eight challenges across three pages. Learn activation and launch; rotate to cross a gap; work around an obstruction; shove a crate onto a switch; use a prop to reach a launch zone; combine two words; solve an order-dependent escape; redirect the villain's large BAM! in the finale. Short comic dialogue adds humor between challenges. The ending recombines established rules.

Controls: A/D or arrows - move; mouse - aim; Q/E - rotate; click or Space - flash; R - reset; Escape - pause. Final bindings will be checked in playtests.

A complete game in 100 hours

A focused core, five owners, early browser testing and a protected release buffer.

TEAM - REQUIRED DETAILS STILL INCOMPLETE

NAME	EMAIL	INDIECONNECT ID
Varun Patil	varun.patil@students.iiit.ac.in	@varunp685
Teammate 2 - pending	pending	pending
Teammate 3 - pending	pending	pending
Teammate 4 - pending	pending	pending
Teammate 5 - pending	pending	pending

Team name: pending. **Track:** pending.

Public GitHub: <https://github.com/varunpatil5050/punchline>

COMMITTED SCOPE

One protagonist and one rotatable force-word system; crates, switches, doors and static hazards; eight challenges, a playable finale and credits; checkpoint recovery, reset, pause and sound controls; a public browser build. Optional extras: cosmetic animation, extra dialogue and replay statistics. Additional combat, enemy AI, procedural generation, multiplayer and a level editor are outside scope.

BUILD AND DELIVERY GATES - FROM OFFICIAL HOUR 0

Planned tool: Godot 4 / GDScript, Compatibility renderer, single-threaded web export. All game code, mechanics and architecture begin during the official development window. **Five owners:** integration/game feel; camera/force system; levels; art/UI; audio/release testing.

HOURS	REVIEWABLE DELIVERABLE
0-8	One challenge with launch, rotation, flash, reset and tested web export.
8-24	Complete core loop and shared components; early hosted build.
24-48	Eight challenges assembled; art and sound integrated.
48-64	Beginning-to-credits run, including the playable finale.
64-82	Fresh-player tests; tune clarity, difficulty and 10-15 minute duration.
82-92	Feature freeze; browser/machine tests; fix completion blockers.
92-100	Final release, documentation and submission buffer.

PRESENTATION AND VALIDATION

Warm paper, black ink, orange words and cyan light; reusable poses, comic impact bursts and tightly timed SFX. Effects remain readable with sound off; flash intensity and shake can be reduced. Test the hosted build on Chromium, Firefox and Safari and observe at least five uncoached first playthroughs, targeting a typical 10-15 minute completion.

ASSETS, AI AND SUBMISSION

Use original, free/open-source, AI-generated or permitted CC assets only. Record every external source/license in root **CREDITS.md** and on itch.io. **Codex/ChatGPT** assisted concept exploration and proposal drafting; disclose any further AI use. Humans own design and final choices. The public repo will carry a proper license, **proposal.pdf** and a README with the itch.io link, setup, controls and team details. Complete registration, team-thread membership and the official form by their deadlines.

DRAFT: fill team name, track and four member records; obtain team review and confirm the official final deadline before submission.